

STAGE TWELVE • LEADERSHIP

FIRSTS

COMPLETION CRITERIA

What counts as done, and how it triggers the Stage Twelve credential

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Completion Criteria & Credential Trigger

Stage Twelve • Leadership

PURPOSE

This document defines exactly what “complete” means for Stage Twelve, at both the individual FIRST level and the full-stage level, and how completion connects to the program's credentialing system. This stage's two capstone FIRSTS, the Leadership Philosophy and Development Plan, get particular attention in the standard below, since a generic, could-apply-to-anyone version of either fails to meet the real bar even if the worksheet field is technically filled in.

Per-FIRST Standard

STANDARD

A FIRST counts as complete when the corresponding Templates worksheet has a genuine, specific answer in every required field, and for FIRSTS involving a real external action (P4's leadership role, P17's difficult conversation, P22's influence attempt), when that action has genuinely been taken or concretely planned with a real date, not just described in the abstract.

Stage-Level Completion Checklist

- All 30 Templates worksheets completed with genuine, specific answers (see per-FIRST standard above).
- Attendance or async completion confirmed for all 3 sessions.
- A genuine leadership philosophy (FIRST P29) written in the participant's own words, grounded in real experience referenced elsewhere in their worksheets, not generic leadership platitudes.
- A specific, time-bound leadership development plan (FIRST P30) with at least three named milestones.

Facilitator Sign-Off

The facilitator reviews each participant's completed Templates workbook, checking specifically that the Leadership Philosophy (P29) and Development Plan (P30) genuinely reflect the participant's own real experiences and priorities rather than generic statements that could apply to anyone. Spot-check for genuine specificity throughout, not just completion.

Credential Trigger

HOW THE BADGE WORKS

Upon facilitator sign-off, the participant's record is marked "Stage Twelve Complete" in the program tracker, which triggers the Stage Twelve digital badge. As with every stage, badges accumulate visibly; the full-program certificate is issued only once all 16 stages are marked complete.